

A Christmas Vision for 1917

Santa Claus Was Most Rocked from his Faith in Humanity Until the Vision Came

With troubled eyes and heavy heart, kind old Santa Claus, on this Christmas Eve, 1917, drove his reindeer through the night. In his thoughts were the battle-fields of Europe, the bereaved homes, the starving children. How could he bring good cheer to this sorrow-stricken world? What gladness could he put into the stockings of his little friends?

Sad and discouraged, Santa Claus gazed at the Christmas Star, which burned before him as he had never seen it, red, angry, menacing. Alas! Had love left the earth? Where was the Christ Child now? Where was the Holy Mother? Where were the Three Wise Men?

As Santa Claus pondered, there appeared a vision in the sky before him; he saw the Holy Family seated on golden thrones, and about them a host of angels. And beneath the angels he saw a vast plain covered with soldiers, that stretched as far as the eye could reach. And some of the soldiers were dead and some were dying.

Now up from the battle-fields came a murmur of voices, cries of rage and pain, curses, prayers. Why had God forsaken them? Why had God allowed this war? Was there never to be any end to their misery? Would no one have pity upon them?

Suddenly, above the highest throne, a new glory appeared, the host of angels bowed in adoration, and a voice more beautiful than anything in Heaven or earth was heard:

The Christ Child: Ye are not forsaken, my brothers; I will have pity. All that ye suffer I have suffered; nor shall your anguish be in vain. Have faith and your eyes shall be opened to understand that life and death are one and the same, now and forever, and that my love, the soul of man triumphs over all things.

The Host of Angels Chanting: Holy, Holy, Holy! Lord God Almighty! Which was and is and is to be.

Now the vision of soldiers vanished and in their places appeared a vast army of women, their bodies bent with grief, their faces despairing. These were the innumerable company of bereaved ones, the mothers, wives, sisters, sweethearts, daughters of the soldiers, the dead and dying soldiers, the mutilated and disfigured soldiers. Through the still night their stifled sobs, their anguished cries ascended. This sorrow was more than they could bear. Why had God put love in their hearts only to torture it? Why

had God let them live through a shameful fate? Why had God will that their little ones should suffer?

Again a radiance shone above the throne, again the angels bowed in adoration as a woman's voice, full of infinite tenderness, made reply:

The Holy Mother: I weep with you, my sisters; I know the bitterness of this dark hour. My heart was torn like yours—it was God's will and for the best. Ye shall find much comfort in comforting others who need you, and so ye shall do God's will.

The Host of Angels Chanting: Only through pain does woman bring forth immortal life; Only through sorrow does woman achieve eternal love.

The vision of women vanished. Silence fell under the vast majesty of night, broken now by a despairing cry, as that once awe-inspiring monarch, Lord and Overlord of all the Russias, lifted a wailing, whimpering prayer from his far Siberian prison. How had he deserved this pitiful fate? Why was he thus cast down, poor and despised, he who had stood so high among the highest, the richest, the mightiest of earth?

Whereupon the most venerable of the Three Wise Men, he whose eyes were deep with serene melancholy, arose and spoke:

The First Wise Man: Weep now, fallen and forsaken Czar, selfish tyrant! Bear now the horrors, the loneliness, the shame of that Siberian hell prepared by thee for those who called thee Little Father. Cry out thy pain, so that earth's remotest, and how little pomp and st dwellers may understand how rain are worldly glory and power palaces avail to redeem an unworthy soul.

The Host of Angels Chanting: Only those are great among men who are great by works of love. Only those who are humble in spirit and have won the blessings of the poor can look upon the Christ Child's face.

Silence again, then ominously the heavens darkened. A peal of thunder shook the all-covering vault, the Star burned with a deeper red and—hark!

An insistent voice from out the purple shadows sounded in clamorous demand, bitter, arrogant, challenging the Omnipotence of Heaven. It was the Great War Lord, the Prince of Arrogance, the Aspire to World Dominion, now thwarted, held at bay, hemmed in by the avenging

forces of an outraged world. Why had mankind turned against him? Had he not battled valiantly as a dauntless ally of the Most High God? Was he not the illustrious Interpreter of God's Will on Earth? How then could God abandon him and permit his enemies to have their way with him?

At which the second of the Three Wise Men, he whose countenance was graven like a rock of justice, lifted his commanding height and answered sternly:

The Second Wise Man: Speak not so confidently of thy God, Wilhelm, lest His lightning smite thee suddenly. Wouldst know why thou art held in abhorrence by all mankind, and thy accursed house with thee? Listen! Like Lucifer, who through pride, fell into darkness from his dazzling archangel glory, so thou by pride hast fallen into darkness. In darkness and blindness thou hast betrayed thine own people, thou hast raged among the nations, ravaging defenseless homes, slaying the wounded, torturing women, drowning mothers with babes at their breasts, visiting thy impious rage upon innocent children, violating every law and promise, until the whole world hates and scorns thee.

The Host of Angels Chanting: Wee! Wee! Wee! On thy knees, with forehead in the dust, Wilhelm, ere the wrath of God descend. Wee to the Hun! Wee to the Hun! Wee to the Hun!

Slowly, with lingering echoes, the mighty song died away, and again the aspect of the heavens changed the shadows lifted, the Star shone with kindlier splendor.

Joyfully now the Heavenly company turned expectant faces toward the western horizon, where a clear, calm voice was making supplication: That on this Christmas Eve new hope might be born into the hearts of men, new readiness for mutual sacrifices that would ensure World Freedom and World Peace. Also that there be vouchsafed to America and the leaders of America strength and wisdom, enabling them to strive worthily and unselfishly for these ends.

Now spoke the youngest of the Three Wise Men, his face radiant with spiritual power, his arms outstretched towards the west, as in a benediction:

The Third Wise Man: Wise and patient thou hast been, President of the greatest of Republics, therefore the strength thou prayest for shall be given thee. It shall be the duty of America to protect the weak from oppression by the strong, not only abroad, but at home, to protect women and children from oppression by men, to protect the poor from oppression by the rich, to guarantee all citizens equal opportunity and just reward for their toil. Thus only can love in its full strength and beauty come into the hearts of all people; love that shall drive out of the world all hatred, envies, jealousies, and realize thy prayer for World Freedom and World Peace.

love that shall make men and women truly the Children of God.

The Host of Angels Chanting: Holy, Holy, Holy! Merciful and mighty!

All Thy works shall praise Thy name In earth and sky and sea.

The vision disappeared. The voices died away. Low in the East the dawn of Christmas Day was breaking. A new joy filled the heart of Santa Claus. With a happy gesture, he caught up his whip and chirped to his reindeer. At last he understood that God had allowed this war so as to make men better, so as to prepare men for a Reign of Love. High over head the Christmas Star was shining, as of old, in golden majesty flashing down its message: PEACE ON EARTH, GOOD WILL TO MEN.

—Ladies' World.

MRS. WILSON BURIED

Wife of Prominent Merchant Taken to Final Resting Place

A great many friends gathered Friday afternoon to pay their last respects to Mrs. Harriet Wilson, wife of Robert D. Wilson, who died at her home here on Wednesday. Rev. H. N. Smith, of the Jennings Lodge congregational church, conducted services from the church and interment was at Mountain View. Mrs. Wilson was 62 years of age. She was born in England and came to this country with her husband, who was a prominent merchant. She was a devoted wife and mother and was well known in the community. Her death was a great loss to her family and friends.

Any Name But That

I've beamed when you hollered "Oh, Girlie!" I've lapped when you bellowed "Oh, say!" I've fallen for "Dearie" and "Missus."

And everything else till today. But there's one thing that's got to be different. From now till the Great War is done—

Unless you're prepared for a riot, You've got to quit calling me "Hun!" —Boston Transcript.

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What Others Like to Eat at Christmastide

SPAIN loves her turkey. Nor does she find it necessary to run them to death on the farms in order to make their meat tender, for the fowls are driven into town from long distances, and their feet are tarred to withstand the hardness of the roads. For three days before Noche Buena the streets of the cities and villages are thick with squawking poultry and bleating lambs and kids that are destined for the slaughter.

Cuba fattens up her turkeys on walnuts to make their flesh more toothsome. Mexico grinds the cooked turkey to a paste, which is mixed with chili, raisins, cranberries, wine and a few other ingredients into what is called mole de guajalote. France, too, although she shows her partiality for turkeys by cramming them with truffles, coquettes with her Christmas menu. Now she throws her scarf to blood red sausage, fat and juicy; now to stewed hare with unfermented wine; again to pheasants, to hazen hens, to heath cocks.

In Brittany the home cured ham gives savor to the rye bread and to the chocolate porridge, especially dedicated to Noel. In Cuba baked hams, preciously boiled in champagne and well sugared, vie for favor with a Spanish piece de resistance called "Moors and Christians." In reminiscence of a page in Spanish history, and made of black beans and rice.

In southern Italy eels, curled round with tail in mouth, defy time on the Christmas board by the emblem of eternity. In the smaller Italian cities on the day before Christmas the air is shrill with cries of kids being brought to market in panniers swung from donkey backs. Chickens, pigeons, tripe, boiling hot, are other dainties appropriate to the season, as well as turkeys, geese and calf's head.

German and Scandinavian countries are noted for the bounty of their Christmas cheer. In rural neighborhoods the tables are spread from Christmas to Epiphany. England, too, offers wide and varied hospitality. In Warwickshire, for instance, they serve roast crab apples with chine of pork and elder wine. Yorkshire has its frummenty, its Yule cakes and plum pudding. Scotland boasts one dish all her own—haddock, stuffed with oatmeal and onions.—Chicago Tribune.

Not Until "Next Christmas."

It was said the other day by an old southerner in Washington that no home loving Virginian ever would move "until after the next Christmas." The next Christmas comes and goes, but there is still another to come, and the moving is put off and happily will be put off until the holiday spirit has gone from the south, a spirit that will go when the south goes.—New York Evening Post.

The Courier and Farmer \$1.00.

A Christmas Gift That Could Not Be Bought.

"One of my most valued gifts this past Christmas was one that money alone could not have bought," said Dolly Wayne in the Philadelphia Ledger. "It was a pot of wild flowers and mosses which had been transplanted from the woods in the early fall and lovingly watched and tended until Christmas time. When the gift came to me the pot and saucer had been prettily decorated, and on the hepatica plants there were numerous buds, which blossomed, some on Christmas day and others later in the week. The gift still affords me daily delight. I have enjoyed those sweet purple and white hepatica blossoms far more than I should have any florist's roses, for I know that the plants were gathered and kept for me by one who understood how dearly I love the woods and the treasures found there."

Her Santa Claus Letter

SHE wrote a note to Santa Claus.

The queerest note that ever was;

'Twas naught but scraps and dots and rings;

But, oh, it meant so many things!

For little girls, strange to believe,

Want many things on Christmas eve.

She asked for dolls all dressed in blue,

And red and pink and purple, too;

She asked for dogs and cats and toys,

And instruments that make a noise;

She asked for candies, cakes and things

And popcorn strung in lengthy strings.

She sent her note to Santa Claus.

The queerest note that ever was.

'Twas naught but scraps and dots and rings;

But, oh, it meant so many things!

—Joe Cone in Woman's Home Companion.

The Courier and Farmer \$1.00.

Poor Outlook.

He—Too bad I haven't had the advantage of an education as well as you, dear.

She—Believe me, you'll get the advantages of mine as soon as we're married.—Chicago News.

HAS CHRIST FAILED

In these war days we are very apt to say that "Christianity has failed." But just what Christianity do we mean? A merely nominal Christianity? Yes, of course it has failed; it failed before the war; it always will fail! A pious Christianity? Of course. A Christianity that thousands have professed and failed to live? Certainly. All these forms of Christianity have failed. So do the same kinds of banks and businesses fail. But does that mean that the idea of a bank or the idea of a business is a failure? Because we misuse a spring, or pollute it, and it brings on disease and the end of human lives, is that the fault of the spring or of the water? "Water has failed." But has it? We know very well that it has not. And exactly the same is true of Christianity—that is, the Christianity of Christ.

Christ has not failed: His doctrines have not failed. It is our failure to accept Christ and his doctrines that is so evident; our wrong conception of Christ's real Christianity—that is at fault. It is we who have failed; not Christianity; not Christ.

We want to remember this distinction at this Christmastide when we would say that "Christianity has failed." For if we say that, then why celebrate Christ's birthday? We don't celebrate the birthdays of failures. And which one of us is ready to say at this Christmastide, with all the weight of war upon us, that Christ has failed?—Ladies' Home Journal.

Cut This Out—It Is Worth Money.

DON'T MISS THIS. Cut out this slip, enclose with 5c and mail it to Foley & Co., 2835 Sheffield Ave., Chicago, Ill., writing your name and address clearly. You will receive in return a trial package containing Foley's Honey and Tar Compound, for coughs, colds, and croup; Foley Kidney Pills, for pain in sides and back, rheumatism, backache, kidney and bladder ailments; and Foley Cathartic Tablets, a wholesome and thoroughly cleansing cathartic for constipation, biliousness, headache and sluggish bowels.—Jones Drug Co.

Farmers Give Bounty

The farmers of the Molalla section have organized for protecting their stock from coyotes. They pay \$15 for every coyote killed within five miles of Molalla. Freeman Thomas and Enoch Skirvin were the first men to claim bounty on the farmers.

Do your Christmas subscription renewing early and get a merchandise order; they are as good as gold.

PAY US A VISIT AND SEE THE HOLIDAY BARGAINS WE'VE PREPARED FOR YOU

WHILE we have not been the largest store in Oregon City selling merchandise, we feel that the friends we have made during past years appreciate our efforts to sell them standard merchandise at popular prices.

We take this opportunity to thank our many customers for their past patronage, and ask for a continuation of valued business

Underwear

For the Family

Our Men's Union Suits are especially good for this season at the price

65c, \$1.00, \$1.35, \$1.85 and \$2.00

Men's Two-piece Underwear

60c, 65c, \$1.00, \$1.25 and \$1.75

Boys' Gray Union Suits in sizes 26 to 34, good heavy garments at 75c

Others according to size 60c, 70c, 75c, 80c, 90c

Ladies' Union Suits, both long and short sleeves. Special at \$1.00

Two-piece Underwear, extra heavy and long, just the thing for this cold weather. Each 75c

Others at 65c and 45c Girls' and Misses' Union Suits, according to size, 60c to 90c

Two-piece Underwear for children 25c, 35c

Announcement

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Good quality Dress Ginghams, all colors, in stripes, plaids and checks. Per yard - - - 15c

Heavy grade Outing Flannel, white and colors, plaids, checks and stripes. Per yard - - - 15c

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